



AKC CGC Prep

CGC Skill 1 · Friendly Stranger Prep Sheet



FITDOG TRAINING ACADEMY

Accepting a Friendly Stranger

Master cgc item 1.

Your dog stays calm while a friendly stranger approaches, speaks to you, shakes your hand, and ignores pushy greetings. This skill sets the tone for the entire CGC evaluation.

TRAINER NOTE

CGC prep is about reliable real-life manners — not perfection under pressure. Practice below threshold, log your reps,

Start here

Dog's name

Target test date

Handler name

Best reward

Know the criteria

Dog allows a friendly stranger to approach and speak to the handler in a

1 **Official skill criteria** Handler shakes hands

Handler mechanics

Keep leash loose — tension invites pulling and jumping.

End on success

Stop while your dog can still think, eat, and cooperate.

CGC ITEM 1

Dog allows a friendly stranger to approach and speak to the handler in a natural, everyday situation. Handler shakes hands and has a brief conversation. Dog shows no shyness or resentment; no jumping on the stranger.

2 **Handler checklist**

- ☐ Keep leash loose — tension invites pulling and jumping. ☐ Stand still. Do not step toward the stranger if your dog surges.
- ☐ Reward four-on-the-floor before the stranger arrives. ☐ If your dog jumps, ask the helper to pause until calm.

Supplies needed

- 6-ft leash
- Front-clip harness
- High-value treats



CGC PRACTICE · FITDOG

3 Step-by-step practice plan

Place your dog in a sit-stay on your left with a loose leash.

Have a helper approach from 20 feet, stop, and ask to pet your dog.

Shake hands with the helper while your dog remains seated or standing calmly.

If your dog jumps, reset distance and repeat with a calmer approach.

End after three clean approaches with no jumping or lunging.

4 Common reasons dogs fail this item

☐ Jumping on stranger

☐ Hiding behind handler

☐ Barking or lunging

☐ Handler correcting harshly on leash

5 Weekly practice log

Date	Setup	Duration	Success 1–5	Notes / next step
Day 1	Easy environment	5 min		
Day 2	Add one distraction	5 min		
Day 3	Hold difficulty	5 min		
Day 4	New location	5 min		
Day 5	Review + film	5 min		

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TEST DAY · READINESS

6 Test-day readiness checklist

FITDOG TRAINER HOMEWORK

A CGC dog greets the world with calm confidence — not excitement at the end of the leash.

- ☐ Dog pottied before ring
- ☐ Treat pouch ready
- ☐ Sit-stay practiced pre-test
- ☐ Stranger approach rehearsed this week

7 Self-score before scheduling your evaluation

Question	Yes	Not yet
Dog succeeds 4/5 reps in practice this week		
Handler can explain criteria without reading notes		
Dog can eat treats in practice environment		
No safety concerns (bite risk, panic, escape)		
Ready to schedule official CGC evaluation		

-  Schedule evaluation — stack wins look solid
-  Another 2 weeks of practice at this skill
-  Contact Fitdog for trainer support

8 Notes for your trainer or evaluator

Observation	Details
Strongest rep this week	
Hardest moment	
Equipment that helped	
Question for test day	